

22 Local Marketing

(Formerly VicTree Websites LLC)

FREE RESOURCE

THE GBP OPTIMIZATION CHECKLIST

Every box a winning Google Business Profile has checked | 22 Local Marketing

Your Google Business Profile decides where you show up on the map, and the map is where most local customers pick a company. This is the same checklist we run for every client: the one-time setup that makes the profile complete, the weekly rhythm that keeps it climbing, and the rules that keep it safe. Print it, check the boxes, or hand it to us.

ONE-TIME SETUP

- ☐ **Business name is your exact real-world name.**
No cities or keywords stuffed in. It reads as spam to customers and it risks suspension with Google.
- ☐ **Primary category matches your money service, plus up to 2 supporting categories.**
Category is one of the biggest map ranking factors. Check what the top 3 competitors in your market use.
- ☐ **Service area covers every city you actually work, and nothing you don't.**
- ☐ **Hours are set, accurate, and match your website exactly.**
Conflicting hours between profile and website is one of the most common trust breaks we find in audits.
- ☐ **Phone number matches the website and every other listing.**
- ☐ **Website is linked, and a booking or quote link is added.**
- ☐ **Business description uses the full 750 characters.**
Written naturally: who you are, what you do, where you do it, and what you stand for. No keyword lists.
- ☐ **Every service is added with its own description.**
Services should mirror your website's service pages, with a link to each where possible.

☐ **Attributes are filled out.**

Veteran-owned, family-owned, free estimates, whatever is true. AI tools quote these directly.

☐ **20+ real photos uploaded: cover, logo, team, at-work, equipment.**

Specs and shot list are in our Photo Optimization Guide.

☐ **Q&A seeded with your 5 most-asked real questions, answered by you.**

If you don't answer them, a stranger eventually will.

☐ **Social profiles linked.**

☐ **Name, address, and phone checked for consistency across the internet.**

Free scanners exist for this. Mismatched listings quietly drag map rankings down. Our Citations List covers where to fix and build.

THE ONGOING RHYTHM

☐ **Weekly: 1-2 posts with a real job photo.**

Posts keep the profile active and give Google fresh, local, service-specific content to read.

☐ **Weekly: 2 new photos from real jobs.**

Upload frequency is an activity signal. Two per week beats forty per quarter.

☐ **Every job: the review ask.**

The laminated QR sheet at the final walkthrough. Full playbook in our Review Management Guide.

☐ **Within 48 hours: respond to every positive review.**

Short, personal, in your own voice.

☐ **Monthly: add 1-2 new Q&A entries.**

☐ **Monthly: upload one short video.**

A 30-second phone clip of a removal or a crane set does the job. Video is still rare on tree service profiles, which is exactly why it stands out.

☐ **Monthly: check the numbers.**

Calls, direction requests, website clicks, and search views. Track leads, not just rankings.

THE RULES THAT KEEP THE PROFILE SAFE

These are the operating rules we hold every client campaign to. Shortcuts on this list are how profiles get suspended.

- **You stay the primary owner of your profile, always.** Anyone who asks to own it for you is taking your business hostage. Managers get manager roles.
- **Real, staffed, customer-facing locations only.** No virtual offices, no fake addresses to fake a second city.
- **Real photos only.** No stock photography.
- **Ask everyone for reviews, never pay for them, never filter who gets asked.**
- **Never respond publicly to a negative review.** Document it, report it if it breaks Google's rules, and settle it offline.

- **Treat "ranking hacks" as poison.** Fake engagement, manipulated links, and review schemes work until they don't, and when they don't, the profile that took years to build disappears.

The honest summary

A complete profile, two small touches a week, a review ask on every job, and zero shortcuts. That is the entire system. It is not complicated, it is just consistent, which is exactly why most competitors never do it.